

Adding and Subtracting in Scientific Notation

MA.8.NSO.1.5

I can add and subtract two numbers written in scientific notation, and write the answer in scientific notation.

Warm-Up

1. Write 0.00062 in scientific notation.
2. How many times larger is 8×10^7 than 2×10^4 ?
3. Find the value: $\sqrt{144}$
4. Find the sum: $0.49 + 1.2$

Warm-Up

1. Write 0.00062 in scientific notation. **6.2×10^{-4}**
2. How many times larger is 8×10^7 than 2×10^4 ? **4,000**
3. Find the value: $\sqrt{144}$ **12**
4. Find the sum: $0.49 + 1.2$ **1.69**

Notes

I. A power of ten is a place value

10^3	10^4	10^5	10^6
thousands	ten thousands	hundred thousands	millions

$$49,500 + 121,000 = 170,500$$

$$4.95 \times 10^4 + 12.1 \times 10^4 = 17.05 \times 10^4 = 1.705 \times 10^5$$

Two numbers can be added only when they carry the same power of ten.

Notes

II. Same power: add or subtract the coefficients

$$(5.2 \times 10^6) + (3.1 \times 10^6) = 8.3 \times 10^6$$

$$(7 \times 10^{-8}) + (6 \times 10^{-8}) = 13 \times 10^{-8} = 1.3 \times 10^{-7}$$

Add or subtract the coefficients. The power of ten does not change.

Then check the coefficient: if it is not between 1 and 10, the answer is not finished.

Notes

III. Different powers: rewrite one of them first

$$(9.4 \times 10^5) - (8.2 \times 10^3)$$

$$= (9.4 \times 10^5) - (0.082 \times 10^5) = 9.318 \times 10^5$$

$$(1.3 \times 10^3) + (3.4 \times 10^5) = 3.413 \times 10^5, \quad \text{never} \quad 4.7 \times 10^8$$

Rewrite one number so both carry the same power of ten, then add or subtract the coefficients.

Exponent up one, decimal point one place left. The value does not move.

Example 1

$$(8.6 \times 10^7) + (5.9 \times 10^7)$$

Add. Write the answer in scientific notation.

Example 1

$$(8.6 \times 10^7) + (5.9 \times 10^7) = 14.5 \times 10^7$$

$$14.5 \times 10^7 = 1.45 \times 10^8$$

145,000,000

Answer: 1.45×10^8

Your Turn

$$(4.8 \times 10^{-3}) + (7.5 \times 10^{-3})$$

Add. Write the answer in scientific notation.

Your Turn

$$(4.8 \times 10^{-3}) + (7.5 \times 10^{-3})$$

Add. Write the answer in scientific notation.

Answer: 1.23×10^{-2}

Example 2

$$(7.3 \times 10^6) - (4.5 \times 10^5)$$

Subtract. Write the answer in scientific notation.

Example 2

$$4.5 \times 10^5 = 0.45 \times 10^6$$

$$(7.3 \times 10^6) - (0.45 \times 10^6) = 6.85 \times 10^6$$

$$7,300,000 - 450,000 = 6,850,000$$

Answer: 6.85×10^6

Your Turn

$$(5.6 \times 10^{-4}) - (9.0 \times 10^{-6})$$

Subtract. Write the answer in scientific notation.

Your Turn

$$(5.6 \times 10^{-4}) - (9.0 \times 10^{-6})$$

Subtract. Write the answer in scientific notation.

Answer: 5.51×10^{-4}

Whiteboards • Question 1 of 9

$$(3.2 \times 10^5) + (4.1 \times 10^5)$$

Answer it.

Whiteboards • Question 1 of 9

$$(3.2 \times 10^5) + (4.1 \times 10^5)$$

Answer: 7.3×10^5

Whiteboards • Question 2 of 9

A stadium sold 4.2×10^4 tickets on Friday
and 3.5×10^4 on Saturday. Each ticket cost 38 dollars.

How many tickets were sold on the two days?

Answer it.

Whiteboards • Question 2 of 9

A stadium sold 4.2×10^4 tickets on Friday
and 3.5×10^4 on Saturday. Each ticket cost 38 dollars.

How many tickets were sold on the two days?

Answer: 7.7×10^4

Whiteboards • Question 3 of 9

$$(6 \times 10^{-5}) + (7 \times 10^{-5})$$

Answer it.

Whiteboards • Question 3 of 9

$$(6 \times 10^{-5}) + (7 \times 10^{-5})$$

Answer: 1.3×10^{-4}

Whiteboards • Question 4 of 9

$$(5.6 \times 10^8) - (4.9 \times 10^8)$$

Answer it.

Whiteboards • Question 4 of 9

$$(5.6 \times 10^8) - (4.9 \times 10^8)$$

Answer: 7×10^7

Whiteboards • Question 5 of 9

$$(1.3 \times 10^3) + (3.4 \times 10^5)$$

Which is the sum?

A. 4.7×10^5

B. 4.7×10^8

C. 3.413×10^5

D. 3.53×10^5

Answer it.

Whiteboards • Question 5 of 9

$$(1.3 \times 10^3) + (3.4 \times 10^5)$$

Which is the sum?

A. 4.7×10^5

B. 4.7×10^8

C. 3.413×10^5

D. 3.53×10^5

Answer: C — 3.413×10^5

Whiteboards • Question 6 of 9

$$(2.5 \times 10^6) + (9.8 \times 10^6)$$

Which is the sum, written in scientific notation?

A. 12.3×10^6

B. 12.3×10^{12}

C. 1.23×10^6

D. 1.23×10^7

Answer it.

Whiteboards • Question 6 of 9

$$(2.5 \times 10^6) + (9.8 \times 10^6)$$

Which is the sum, written in scientific notation?

A. 12.3×10^6

B. 12.3×10^{12}

C. 1.23×10^6

D. 1.23×10^7

Answer: D — 1.23×10^7

Whiteboards • Question 7 of 9

$$(7.8 \times 10^{-2}) - (6.4 \times 10^{-3})$$

Answer it.

Whiteboards • Question 7 of 9

$$(7.8 \times 10^{-2}) - (6.4 \times 10^{-3})$$

Answer: 7.16×10^{-2}

Whiteboards • Question 8 of 9

$$(4.5 \times 10^6) + (n \times 10^6) = 1.02 \times 10^7$$

What is the value of n ?

Answer it.

Whiteboards · Question 8 of 9

$$(4.5 \times 10^6) + (n \times 10^6) = 1.02 \times 10^7$$

What is the value of n ?

Answer: $n = 5.7$

Whiteboards • Question 9 of 9

Devon writes $(1.3 \times 10^3) + (3.4 \times 10^5) = 4.7 \times 10^8$.

Name the two mistakes he made, and give the correct sum.

Write your answer in sentences.

Whiteboards • Question 9 of 9

Devon writes $(1.3 \times 10^3) + (3.4 \times 10^5) = 4.7 \times 10^8$.

Name the two mistakes he made, and give the correct sum.

Answer: 3.413×10^5

Independent Set

1. Six questions. Work down the page.
2. Show the step that does the work, not just the answer.
3. Silence until the six minutes are up.

IXL

1. Open IXL and start today's skills.
2. Work on paper where the question needs work. The answer box does not show it.
3. Every skill listed is required, to a SmartScore of 67. Due at the start of the next class.

Today's skills — all required

Add and subtract numbers written in scientific notation — HUR